Project Shield Our Elders

Brevard County, Florida

Scam warning checklist

For unexpected calls and messages

Use this checklist to review unexpected requests, and verify the source before acting even when none of these signs appears.

- ☐ Pressure to act now or stay on the phone
- ☐ Instructions to keep the request secret
- ☐ Threats of arrest or lost benefits
- ☐ An unexpected family emergency
- ☐ Gift cards, crypto, wires, or app payments
- ☐ Transfers to a “safe account”
- ☐ Requests for a password or sign-in code
- ☐ Requests for bank, Social Security, or Medicare details
- ☐ Device access or software installation
- ☐ Unexpected links, QR codes, or invoices

When something feels wrong

End the conversation without clicking, paying, sharing information, or installing software, then call someone you trust or the organization through a number you already know.

A common example

A caller claiming to be from your bank says your account is in danger and asks you to keep it secret while moving your money. The secrecy and transfer request are warning signs; end the call and contact the number on your bank card.

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My trusted contact plan

Who to call before sending money or sharing information

Complete this privately with someone you trust and keep it near your phone. Workshop staff should count completion without collecting this page.

Trusted contact _____ **Phone** _____

Backup contact _____ **Phone** _____

Bank or card provider _____ **Number from my card or statement** _____

Keep account numbers, PINs, and passwords off this page.

Our family emergency plan

Choose a private phrase together and keep it in a separate private place, away from cards you carry and workshop forms.

☐ We have chosen a phrase and practiced using it.

☐ We have saved known numbers for the people in our plan.

For an unexpected emergency, ask for the phrase without hints and call the relative at a saved number. If they cannot be reached, contact another relative before sending money, even if the phrase was correct.

A trusted friend, neighbor, caregiver, or staff member can also agree to help if family is not available.